

underpinning of your family's success. If you spend, save and invest wisely, the assets you have today will become even greater assets tomorrow.

The cost of losing these assets is very high. Take Mitchell Clayton, who ran his most important relationships through the shredder, whether he wanted to or not. Mitchell wound up unhappy, with a broken home and a heart-stopping alimony payment. Why? Because he didn't realize the value his wife brought to their family until it was too late. Mitchell's partnership with Judy—in which he'd invested over 30 years of equity—was the most valuable asset in his life, and now he'll never be able to get it back.

But if you make the *right* choices, you can protect and grow your assets. When you reduce debt and protect your personal and business relationships, when you set financial targets and are responsible enough to meet them, you're not only creating success in *your* lifetime—you've just set your kids up for success in the future as well. And if you build a dynasty properly, introducing family values to your children, they will avoid the fate of some young people today who learn only to be entitled bloodsuckers feeding off the family fortune. Your kids will learn that to be part of the dynasty, they have to contribute to it, too.

I'm not saying a family dynasty is all about money. But it takes money to create security, stability and freedom for the important people in your life—yourself, your partner and your kids. The cold hard truth is that too many people think they can build a family out of dreams and good intentions; then they end up living below the poverty line with four kids and not nearly enough resources to live a good life. I'll tell you right now: the road to financial ruin is paved with dreams and good intentions. Your kids don't deserve to be destitute, and neither do you.

In this book, I'll show you how to build and maintain a strong dynasty and how to make sound financial choices that will keep you secure, now and well into the future. I'll show you how to make smart money and life decisions, from choosing a partner who increases your financial and emotional security, to paying off your mortgage and growing your savings, to showing your children how